June 1989.[72] India's pro-Najibullah policy had no moral sanction in the light of the Soviet Union's brazen invasion of Afghanistan. 'The stridently aggressive attitude towards the neighbours is digested by pseudo-nationalists alone. The common man fails to understand the fire-and-brimstone diplomacy' whereas India's 'national allergy to "Muslim fundamentalism"' seemed misplaced.[73] Citing India's recognition of the Palestinian Liberation Organisation (PLO), the article sought a rectification of India's initial wrong (Gandhi's pro-Soviet U-turn in 1980) and recognition of the Mujahideen government. All indicators favoured the rise of the conciliators in 1992.

The MEA's annual reports indicate how dominant the conciliators were till 1996, when Kabul fell to the Taliban. Post-1996 India breached almost all tenets of the Rao doctrine. In 1991–92, the MEA, apart from detailing bilateral visits and Indian aid figures to Afghanistan under the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation programme, stated that:

> India continued to extend full support to the political settlement of the Afghan crisis based on her conviction that any such settlement should recognise the legitimate interests of all concerned and be arrived at by the Afghans themselves without any external interference.[74]

Of particular importance here is India's recognition of legitimate interests of all concerned, which included the Mujahideen. Coming at a time when Najibullah was still in power and Kashmir was burning, the statement reflected a mood of broad-based political reconciliation. In 1992 and 1993, India's primary position remained the same on 'all concerned entering a dialogue', and New Delhi 'urgently' called for a 'renewed international peace initiative, possibly under UN auspices'. Throughout this period, the MEA assessed India-Pakistan relations as showing a 'downward trend', much like the situation on the ground in Kashmir.[75] Regardless of this downward trend in its relations with Pakistan, and the worsening Afghan civil war with the different Mujahideen factions fighting each other to grab power in Kabul, India remained on a conciliatory path. On 7 March 1993, Pakistan brokered what is known as the 'March accord' in its attempt to stabilise the situation and form an effective interim government in Kabul. Instead of undermining the accord, India welcomed it with the hope that it would bring peace to Afghanistan.[76] In 1994, while India was still coming to terms with the capabilities of the newly formed Taliban, the MEA reported that